

Dan Brodtkin

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Citizenship: USA, Canada

Research Syntax; Prosody; Extended Projection; A-Ā Divide; Structure of the PF Branch

Employment **University of Pennsylvania** Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Postdoctoral Fellow in Syntax September 2025 – Present

Education **University of California, Santa Cruz** Santa Cruz, California
PhD in Linguistics September 2018 – August 2025

Carleton College Northfield, Minnesota
BA in Linguistics; BA in History September 2014 – June 2018

Scholarships Graduate Research Fellowship (National Science Foundation) 2018-2023
Predoctoral Fellowship (University of California, Santa Cruz) 2018-2024
Fulbright Research Fellowship (US Department of State) 2018-2019
Critical Language Enhancement Award (US Department of State) 2018
Critical Language Scholarship (US Department of State) 2017

Journal Publications

Under Revision

Pseudopassives, Pied-Piping, and A-Movement of PPs

Subject Positions, High Absolutives, and Austronesian Voice

Chain Reduction at the Syntax-Prosody Interface

Accepted

Demonstratives, Reinforcers, and Movement to the Right

Linguistic Inquiry

Accepted

The Prosody of Paths

with Revisions

Syntactic Theory and Research

Explaining the Ban on Ergative Anaphors

Glossa

First author; with Justin Royer

2025

The Prosody of the Extended VP

Natural Language and Linguistic Theory

Suppletion in Global Perspective

Linguistic Inquiry

2022

Two Steps to High Absolutive Syntax

The Journal of East Asian Linguistics

Invited

Contributions

In Prep

Voice

The Routledge Handbook of Syntax, Second Edition

with Mitcho Erlewine

To Appear

The Phonology of Indonesian

The International Encyclopedia of Language and Linguistics, Third Edition

2024

Constraining Subcategory-Sensitive Match Constraints

Syntax-Prosody in Optimality Theory: Theory and Analyses

(*Advances in Optimality Theory*)

with Nick van Handel and Ben Eischens

Working Papers

2024

The Ban on Ergative Anaphors

Proceedings of WCCFL 39

with Justin Royer

2022

Perception Verb Complements in Mandarin

Syntax and Semantics at Santa Cruz V

Two Steps to High Absolutive Syntax

MA Thesis; UCSC

2021

Anti-Agreement is Syntactic: Evidence from South Sulawesi

Proceedings of NELS 51

Second-Position Clitics and Prosodic Recursion

Proceedings of AMP 2020

Object Shift and Agent Extraction in Mandarin

Proceedings of AFLA 27

2020

Pseudoclefts and Parameters in the Pacific

Syntax and Semantics at Santa Cruz IV

Invited Talks

2026

Time Travel in the Mandarin TP

Boston Morphology Workshop (EXO-Words IV)

A-Syntax at the Edge

Speaker Series; Georgetown University

2024	The Prosody of Paths Phonological Domains Workshop; UC Berkeley
Around Indonesia (Titles translated)	
2025	The Importance of Research on the Languages of West Sulawesi The University of West Sulawesi, Majene
2023	Poetic Meter in the Languages of Sulawesi Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta
	Challenges in Regional Language Pedagogy Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta
2023	Ellipsis, Minimality, and Movement in Mandar The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya, Jakarta
	Why Generative Linguistics? The View from a Regional Language The National Institute for Research and Innovation, Makassar; <i>with Jupri Talib</i>
	Functional Word Lengthening in Mandar: A Generative Perspective Hasanuddin University, Makassar
2022	Linguistic Theory at the Frontiers of Cross-Cultural Understanding The Language Office of East Java, Surabaya
	Universal Grammar in West Sulawesi Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta
	Phonological Displacement in Mandar The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya, Jakarta
2019	Language Death in Indonesia Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta
	Pseudoclefts and Pied Piping with Inversion in Mandar Summer Linguistics Meet-Up; National University of Singapore
	Clitic Placement in the Languages of South Sulawesi Kolita 17; The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya, Jakarta
	Language Death in Indonesia East Asia-Pacific Fulbright Regional Conference; Taipei

Conference Talks		The Linguistic History of Sulawesi State University of Malang, Malang	
	2024	The Prosody of Paths AFLA 31; UMass Amherst	
		Metrical Structure in Mandar Phonology and Poetry Kolita 22; Atma Jaya University; <i>with Maria Tamarina Prawati and Jupri Talib</i>	
		The Prosody of the Extended VP Annual Meeting of the Linguistics Society of America	
	2023	Pemindahan Kata dalam sebuah bahasa di Sulawesi (Rightward Movement in a language of Sulawesi) 3rd Annual AIFIS-MSU Conference on Indonesian Studies	<i>with Jupri Talib</i>
	2022	Prosodic Greed in Mandar TripleAFLA; University of Manchester	
		Apa itu Subyek? Perspektif Dari Sulawesi (What's a Subject? A Perspective from Sulawesi) 2nd Annual AIFIS-MSU Conference on Indonesian Studies	<i>with Jupri Talib</i>
	2021	Philippine Voice and Split Absolutive Syntax AFLA 28; McGill University	
		Two Constraints on Ergative Anaphors AFLA 28; McGill University	<i>with Justin Royer</i>
		Wh-Movement in Mandar 95th Meeting of the LSA; San Francisco	
	2020	Object Shift and Agent Extraction in Mandar AFLA 27; NUS	
Posters			
	2024	Height and Locality in Mandar $\bar{A}$-Extraction AFLA 31; UMass Amherst	
	2022	Existential Match: Evidence from Mandar AMP 2022; UCLA	
	2021	Ergative Anaphors and High Absolutive Syntax WCCFL 39; University of Arizona, Tucson	<i>with Justin Royer</i>

2020 **Anti-Agreement is Syntactic: Evidence from South Sulawesi**
NELS 51; UQAM

Second Position and Prosodic Recursion
AMP 2020; UC Santa Cruz

Reading Group Talks

2026 **Syntax Workshop**; University of Massachusetts, Amherst
S-Lab; University of Maryland, College Park
Syntax Reading Group; Yale University

2025 **Syntax Reading Group**; Yale University

2023 **Syntax Reading Group**; Yale University
Smircle; Stanford University

2022 **Syntax Brown Bag**; New York University

2021 **Syntax and Semantics Circle**; UC Berkeley

2020 **Fieldwork Lab**; McGill University

2019 **Syntax Reading Group**; National University of Singapore

Teaching at UCSC

Ling 112: Syntax 1
Fall 2024 Teaching assistant; with Roumyana Pancheva
Fall 2020 Teaching assistant; with Jorge Hankamer

Ling 50: Intro to Linguistics
Spring 2025 Teaching assistant; with Grant McGuire
Winter 2025 Teaching assistant; with Andrew Angeles

Spring 2024 **Ling 80K: Invented Languages**
Teaching assistant; with Andrew Angeles

Fall 2021 **Ling 53: Semantics 1**
Teaching assistant; with Maziar Toosarvandani

Service

AMERICA **Reviewer**, Oxford Handbook of Clitics 2026
Reviewer, Natural Language & Linguistic Theory 2024, 2025, 2026
Reviewer, Oceanic Linguistics 2021

INDONESIA

Praat Workshops

Bina Nusantara University	2024
The National Research and Innovation Agency	2023
The Language Office of South Sulawesi	2022

Undergraduate Syntax. Guest Lecturer.

Department of English, Bina Nusantara University	
Main Instructors: Clara Herlina Karjo, Menik Winiharti	2023

Generative Grammar. Guest Lecturer.

Department of Linguistics, The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya	
Main Instructor: Yassir Tjung	2019

Advising

External Ph.D Thesis Committee Member

Siti Mafulah	
“Exploring student engagement with corrective feedback in EFL classrooms.”	
State University of Malang, Faculty of Literature	2022

External Undergraduate Thesis Committee Member

Jupri Talib	
“An Analysis of Rhyme and Rhythm in the Mandar Poetry of West Sulawesi”	
Kanjuruhan University of Malang, Faculty of Letters	2022

Coordinated Reading Groups

Syntax Lab

University of Pennsylvania	2025 – Present
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The Morphology Reading Group (MRG)

UC Santa Cruz	2020 – 2023
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The Syntax-Prosody Reading Group

Zoom: UCSC; McGill; MIT; NUS; Lund	2020 – 2021
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Labeling Out of Control

Zoom: UCSC; NYU; University of Chicago	2020 – 2021
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Undergraduate Syntax Club

UC Santa Cruz	2020 – 2023
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Languages

Native: English

Professional: Indonesian

Conversational: Javanese, Mandar, French

Other: $\LaTeX$, Praat, FLEx, Python, German, Spanish, Greek (Ancient/Medieval)